UTHM INDUSTRY VISIT

16 DECEMBER 2025

SUMMARY OF THE TALK

this visit is to provide students with exposure to real-world IT operations in a university environment. During the visit, students were introduced to UTHM's main systems, including the Student Management Portal (SMAP), which is used to manage student information and academic processes.

The session also highlighted UTHM's IT infrastructure, especially the university data center. It was shared that the data center has been expanded from a smaller facility into a larger and more advanced one to support increasing system usage and data demands.

In addition, students participated in group discussions related to enterprise architecture based on the TOGAF framework. These activities helped students connect classroom knowledge with real organisational practices. Overall, the visit provided valuable insights into IT systems, infrastructure, and enterprise management at UTHM.

RELFECTION (DAMIYA)

This industry visit helped me gain a clearer view of how information technology supports daily operations in a university. From the session, I understood that systems like the Student Management Portal are important for managing student information efficiently. I also learned that having a well-developed data center is essential to support increasing data usage and system performance. The visit showed me how IT infrastructure must be planned carefully to ensure reliability and long-term growth.

THE TECHNOLOGIES AND ISSUES DISCUSSED IN THE TALK

One of the technologies discussed during the industrial visit was the WAF (Web Application Firewall) system used in the data center. The WAF system helps protect web applications by monitoring and filtering incoming network traffic to prevent cyber attacks.

The data center also uses a hot aisle and cold aisle layout with air cooling only. Cold air is supplied to the servers through the cold aisle, while hot air is released through the hot aisle. This setup helps maintain a stable temperature and improves cooling efficiency.

However, the talk also highlighted some issues. Air cooling has limitations when server workloads increase, as it may not dissipate heat efficiently. Therefore, proper monitoring and airflow management are important to ensure reliable data center operations.

In addition, UTHM uses a single master database for its main systems, such as the learning management system and student system. These systems get data from the master database through APIs or direct data access. This helps keep the data consistent and the systems running smoothly.

RELFECTION (ALIF FATHI)

This industrial visit helped me understand how a data center is designed and managed in a real environment. I learned about cooling layouts, system monitoring, and how different university systems are connected through a centralized database. Overall, the visit increased my awareness of the importance of data center management in supporting daily university operations.

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